

6.2 Filters

Filters in general sense means something that removes the impurities and gets back the pure form. Filters in Flash CS3 is nothing but a feature that adds refined visual effects to text, buttons and Movie clips. These visual effects includes drop shadow, blur, glow, gradient glow, gradient bevel and bevel. Filters do not change the symbols permanently. So, you can add filters on different instances of the same symbols and whenever you feel like it, remove them. Here you can adjust the brightness, contrast, saturation and hue level in the Movie clip by using the adjust color filters. By using Filter tab in Properties Inspector or Action script filters effects can be applied to Movie clips, buttons or text fields.

Using Flash filters enables you to create beautiful graphics. One of the unique characteristic in Flash is the provision of animating the filters by using motion Tween. Let us consider one example for instance, if you create a ball using drop shadow, you will find the light source moving from one side of the object to another by changing its position in the Timeline. While applying Filters you can set up the orders of filters in your own way to try out with combined effects. Apart from this if you wish you can enable and disable filters or even delete them from the Property Inspector. Just by selecting the object you can view the filters applied to it, this will automatically modify the filters list in the Property Inspector.

You can use Filters in practical sense. Suppose you want to float something over the stage. What you need to do is to apply drop shadow filter to a clip. Let us consider one example, suppose you want to desaturate a photo and give it a black and white look. What will you do? You have to do nothing but import one photo you want to desaturate and then convert it to a Movie clip symbol. Then from the filters panel select 'Adjust color' and then adjust the saturation slider to the left and set it to -100. If you want you can also give a yellow tinge by adjusting the Hue slider. So after reading this you can apply Filters in practical sense.

Do you know filters cannot be used independently? It is dependent upon the object instance to which you apply the filters.